

VICIDE CREAM 5%

DESCRIPTION:

A white to off white, smooth homogeneous mass.

COMPOSITION:

Each gm of the cream contains Acyclovir (Micronised) 50mg

Preservative(s):

Methylparaben 0.2% w/w

Propylparaben 0.05% w/w

ACTIONS & PHARMACOLOGY:

Acyclovir is converted to acyclovir monophosphate, a nucleotide by herpes simplex virus (HSV)-coded thymidine kinase. Acyclovir monophosphate is converted to the diphosphate by cellular guanylate kinase and to the triphosphate by a number of cellular enzymes. Acyclovir triphosphate interferes with HSV DNA polymerase and inhibits viral DNA replication. The triphosphate can be incorporated into growing chains of DNA by viral DNA polymerase, resulting in termination of the DNA chain. Since acyclovir is preferentially taken up and selectively converted to the active triphosphate form by HSV-infected cells, it is much less toxic to normal uninfected cells.

Absorption:

Intact skin - Minimal; acyclovir not detected in blood or urine.

Diseased skin (Herpes zoster) – Moderate; serum concentrations up to 0.28mcg per ml have been reported in patients with normal renal function and up to 0.78 mcg/ml in patients with impaired renal function.

Elimination:

The absorbed drug is excreted in the urine

INDICATIONS:

Topical acyclovir is indicated for the treatment of herpes simplex virus infections of skin including initial and recurrent genital herpes and herpes labialis.

CONTRAINDICATIONS:

Contraindicated in patients who are sensitive to topical acyclovir or propylene glycol.

SIDE EFFECTS:

Transient pain, burning or stinging sensation on application may occur. Mild drying or flaking of the skin, erythema, itching and rarely, contact dermatitis, have also been reported.

PRECAUTIONS:

Use of topical antivirals may lead to skin sensitization, resulting in hypersensitivity reactions with subsequent topical or systemic use of acyclovir. Topical acyclovir is for cutaneous use only. It should not be used in the eyes. Special care should be taken to avoid accidental introduction into the eyes. Topical acyclovir is also not recommended for application to buccal or vaginal mucous membrane. Animal studies indicate that reversible irritation may result from introduction of the cream into the vagina.

Carcinogenicity, mutagenicity and effect on fertility:

Acyclovir was not carcinogenic in long-term studies in the rat and mouse. In vitro and in vivo mutagenicity tests indicate that acyclovir is unlikely to pose a genetic risk to man. In two-generation studies in mice, acyclovir has been shown to have no effects on fertility.

Acyclovir has been shown to have no definitive effects upon sperm count, morphology or motility in man. However, there is no experience of the effects of acyclovir on human female fertility.

PREGNANCY AND LACTATION:

Systemic administration of acyclovir to rats and rabbits did not produce embryotoxic or teratogenic effect. However, no information is available on the effects of administration of acyclovir during pregnancy. In addition, no information is available on the levels of acyclovir in breast milk after administration of the drug. Therefore, acyclovir should be used with caution during pregnancy and lactation and the potential benefits of treatment should be balanced against any possible risk.

DRUG INTERACTIONS:

Probenecid increases mean half-life and area under the plasma concentration curve of systemically-administered acyclovir. Clinical experience has not identified other drug interactions with acyclovir.

DOSAGE & ADMINISTRATION:

Apply a sufficient quantity to cover all lesions adequately. Apply 5 to 6 times daily at approximately 4-hourly intervals for 5 to 10 days. Therapy should be initiated as soon as possible following the onset of signs and symptoms of herpes infection; for recurrent episodes this should preferably be during the prodromal period or when lesions first appear.

ROUTE OF ADMINISTRATION:

Topical Administration

OVERDOSAGE & TREATMENT:

Acute overdosage with the topical application of the drug is unlikely. If irritation or sensitivity reactions occur, use of the medication should be discontinued.

EFFECTS ON ABILITY TO DRIVE AND USE MACHINE

Not Applicable

PRESENTATION:

Aluminium tubes of 5g and 10g.

STORAGE:

Store in a cool place below 30°C.

Keep the containers tightly closed. For external use only.

Keep medicine out of reach of children. Protect from light and freezing.

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